



Releasing

Given a customer scenario, describe and recommend an appropriate release management strategy.

Develop your career with Salesforce Training and Certification Preparation

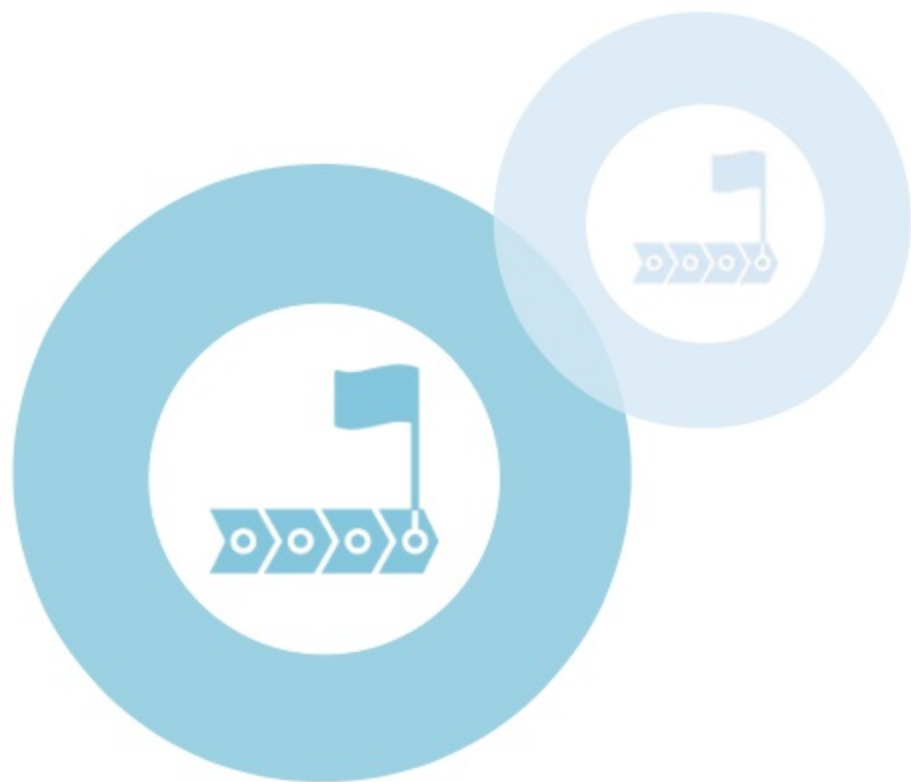
Table of Contents

-  [Release Management Strategies](#)
-  [Business Scenario](#)
-  [Requirements & Solutions](#)



After studying this topic, you should be able to:

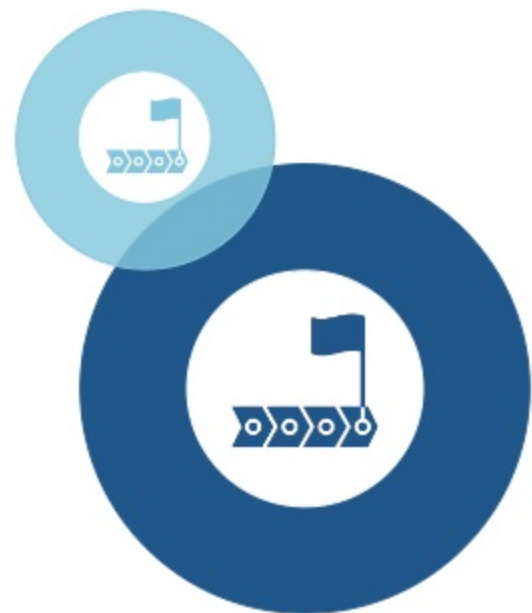
-  Describe the various aspects of release management, including the evaluation of new projects.
-  Explain the different types of releases that can be incorporated in a release management strategy.
-  Explain the responsibilities of the groups responsible for the creation and execution of release management.
-  Identify the sample release paths for different types of Salesforce releases.
-  Recommend appropriate release management strategies for the given business requirements.



Introduction

In today's rapidly evolving business landscape, developing a robust **release management strategy** tailored to specific customer scenarios is crucial for the integrity and efficiency of Salesforce projects. This approach involves analyzing the customer's operational requirements, development processes, and business goals to devise a strategic plan that ensures smooth, consistent, and successful deployment of Salesforce updates.

By incorporating **different types of releases (immediate, minor, major, and hotfix)** in their release management strategy, organizations can significantly enhance the delivery of new functionality on their Salesforce platform. An effective release management strategy aligns releases with business objectives, facilitating seamless integration of new features and improvements.



Release Management Strategies

Types Of Releases

There are three main types of releases (immediate, minor, and major). In addition, hotfixes are utilized for resolving urgent issues in production.

Release Management Groups

Center Of Excellence and Steering Committee are responsible for the creation and execution of release management processes.

Release Paths

Specific release paths can be followed for different types of Salesforce releases. For instance, a hotfix can be tested in UAT and then deployed to production.

Release Management

Release Management is the continuous process that comprises specific stages that should be followed for every successful release.

New Project Evaluation

Evaluation of new projects in the release management process consist of new project submission, new project submission/support, project prioritization, and project decision.



Release Management Strategies

[Table of Contents](#)



Release Management

Release Management is the **continuous process** that comprises **specific stages** that should be followed for every **successful release**.

❖ PROCESS

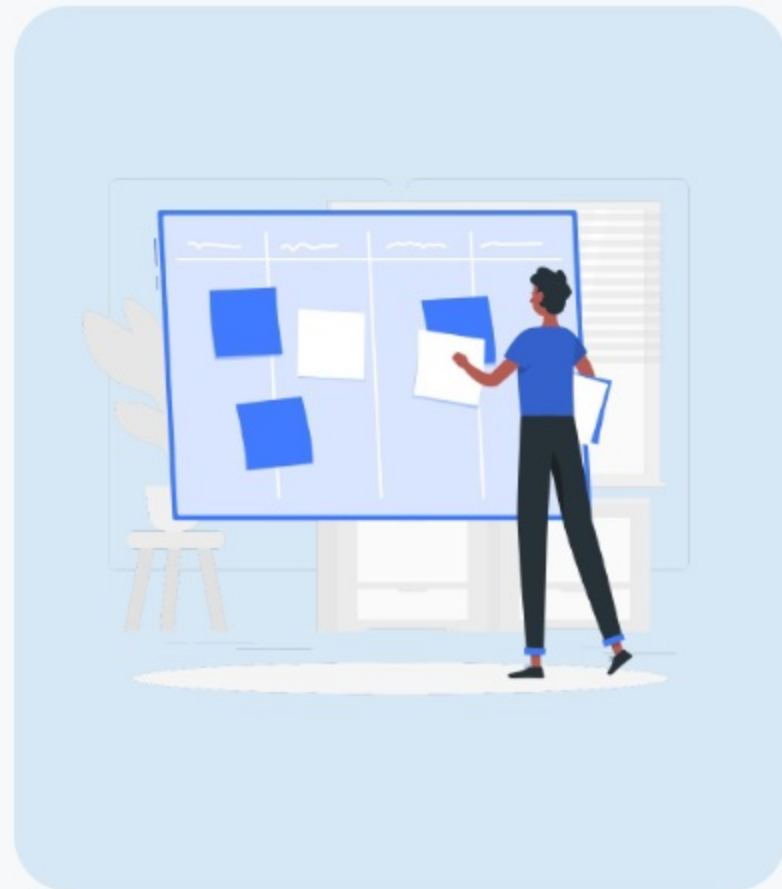
Typically, release management comprises **planning, requirement gathering, solution design, build, test, release, and maintenance**.

❖ STEPS

Each step of the release management process is **essential** and should be **fully completed** before moving onto the next step.

❖ PILLARS

The main pillars of release management are **deployment size and cadence, new project evaluation, environment strategy, training and communication, and ongoing support**.



Release Management

Release Management is the **continuous process** that comprises **specific stages** that should be followed for every **successful release**.

❖ RELEASE PLANNING

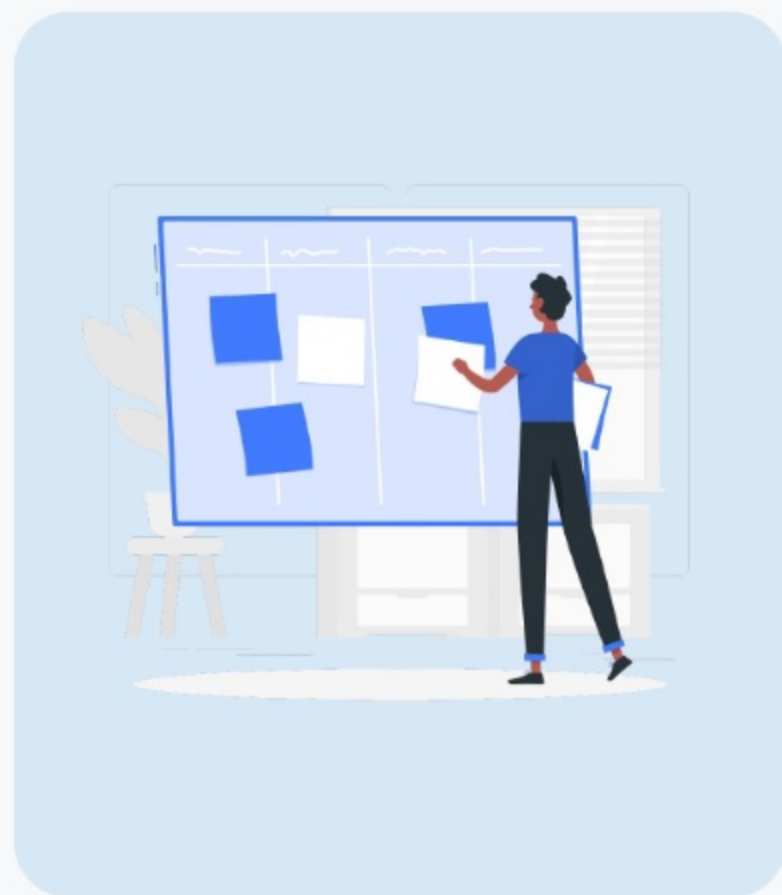
Release planning involves **understanding the components** being developed, **anticipating potential conflicts**, and **scheduling features** for each release.

❖ RELEASE SCHEDULE

A release schedule should be established for a project. **Scheduled release milestones** should be added to the **project schedule** to aid planning.

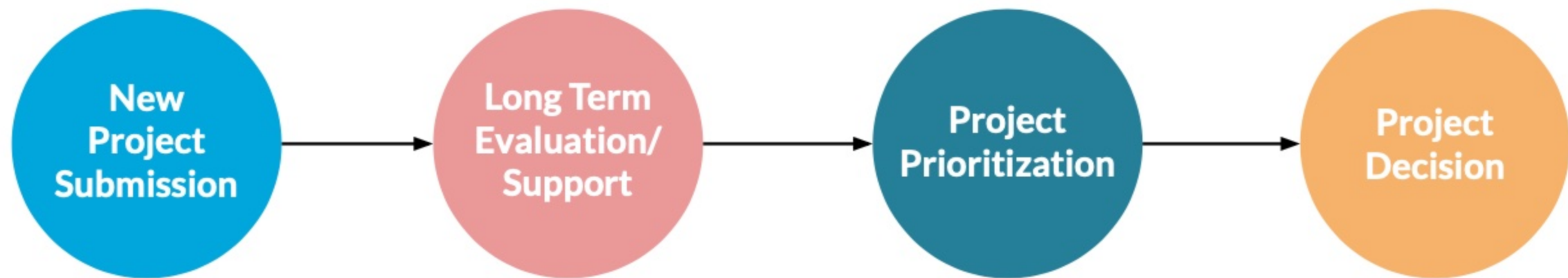
❖ PROJECT EVALUATION

Project evaluation involves **submission of a project request** to the **COE (Center Of Excellence)**, **evaluation** of short term and long term alignment with the goals, project **prioritization**, and project **decision**.



Release Management

Evaluation of new projects in the release management process consist of multiple steps.



A **communication process** is defined for the new project, the **project request is submitted to the COE**, and **project information** is entered into the database.

The COE **evaluates** the **short term** and **long term alignment** with the goals, alignment with **ongoing** or **other pending projects**, how **project will be supported**, and **administrative needs**.

New project requests are **reviewed** as part of a COE meeting, **business priority** and **alignment with the overall program roadmap** are determined, and **priorities** are defined in the **COE project database**.

The COE advises on **project strategy** and **timing**, informs the **Steering Committee** about upcoming projects, and **communicates decision** to sponsors. **Relevant individuals** join the COE for **advancing projects**.

Types of Releases

There are **three main types of releases** that should be considered while devising a release management strategy.



IMMEDIATE

Immediate releases involve **small changes** that are often rapidly applied directly in production. Their impact on users is **minimal**, and they are **outside the scope** of change process.



MINOR

Minor releases involve **minor changes** that impact **two or more groups of users**. They are **thrice as often** as a major release and have **minor impact** on training and production.



MAJOR

Major releases involve **significant changes** and are often **aligned with platform releases**. They have **major impact** on production and integration **across more than one business unit**.

Types of Releases

There are **three main types of releases** that should be considered while devising a release management strategy.



IMMEDIATE

Immediate releases require **low level of effort**, **no** training, and **no** integration. They can be implemented by a **BA (Business Analyst)**.



MINOR

Minor releases require **medium level of effort**, **less than one day** of training, and **less than one week** of configuration time. Their implementation requires **IT involvement**.



MAJOR

Major releases require **high level of effort**, **more than one day** of training, **more than one week** of configuration time, **more than one week** of integration development time, and **IT Lead's** involvement.

Types of Releases

There are **three main types of releases** that should be considered while devising a release management strategy.



IMMEDIATE

Immediate releases are often implemented **daily**. Examples include reports, dashboards, related lists, data loads, territory assignments, etc.



MINOR

Minor releases are often implemented **monthly**. Examples include new objects, fields, page layouts, flows, triggers, etc.



MAJOR

Major releases are often implemented **quarterly**. Examples include AppExchange apps, process impacting changes, data migration, integration changes, etc.

Hotfixes

A hotfix is a **small change** that is applied to resolve an **urgent production issue**.



QUICK ROLLOUT

Hotfixes have a **fast rollout path** to address a burning production issue. The release path is typically defined at the time of evaluating the required change.



UAT

User acceptance testing (UAT) **may or may not be required**, depending on the nature of change. The hotfix could be **directly applied** in production.



DOWNSTREAM

The **deployment** should flow through **all downstream environments**, ensuring that the change is replicated to the other environments.

Release Management Groups

Two groups are responsible for the **creation and execution** of release management processes.

STEERING COMMITTEE

The Steering Committee provides **strategic direction and oversight**. It typically consists of **senior stakeholders** whose role involves decision-making on priorities, resource allocation, and addressing any conflicts or changes in direction, ensuring that the release management processes support the organization's objectives.

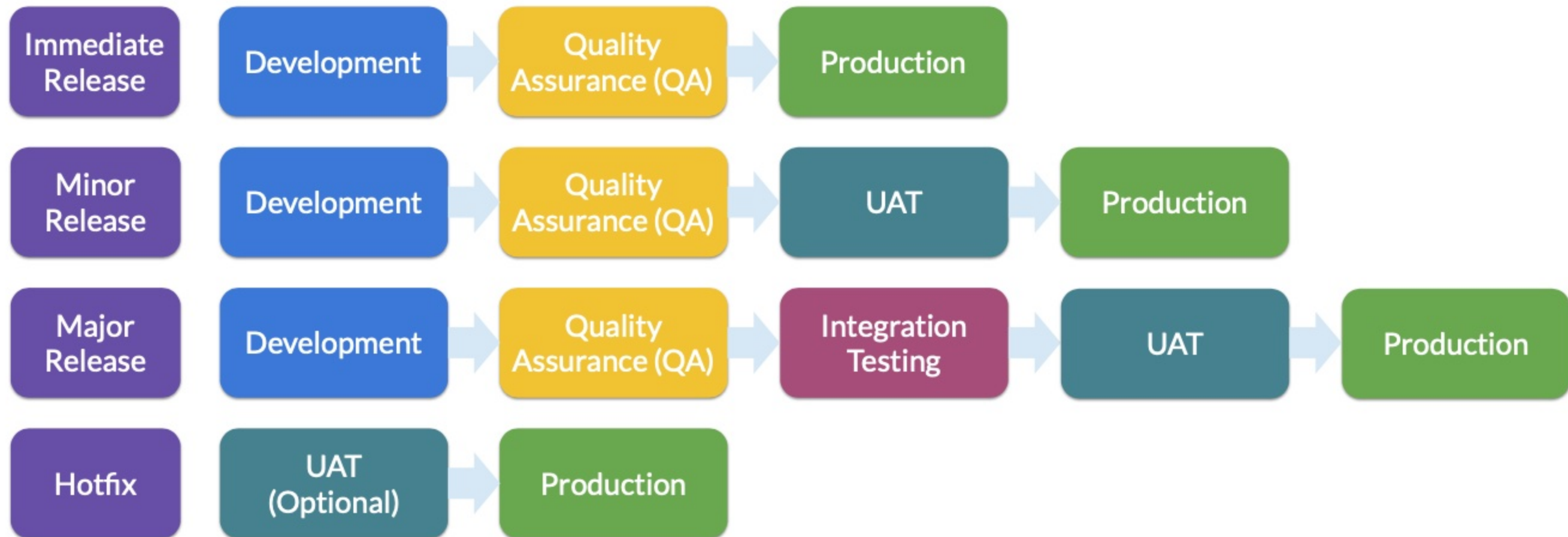


CENTER OF EXCELLENCE (COE)

The Center of Excellence (COE) plays a pivotal role in **standardizing and overseeing the execution of release management processes**. It establishes best practices, methodologies, and guidelines to be followed. It acts as a governing body that works closely with development teams to ensure consistency, efficiency, and quality.

Release Paths

The diagram below shows the **sample release paths** that may be followed for **different types of releases** in Salesforce.



Business Scenario

Table of Contents 

Business Scenario

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Manufacturing Solutions, a leader in the industrial sector, is set to enhance its Salesforce platform, focusing on Sales Cloud and Service Cloud enhancements. These updates aim to optimize the sales pipeline management, improve customer service processes, and ensure seamless integration with its manufacturing operations system. Projects include customizing Sales Cloud to improve tracking of sales opportunities and leveraging Service Cloud to enhance post-sale support and service request tracking.

The company's Salesforce architect faces the task of devising release management strategies for the development and deployment of the enhancements. The strategies must ensure that the enhancements are implemented effectively, improving operational efficiency and customer satisfaction without disrupting ongoing sales and service activities.

Requirements & Solutions

[Table of Contents](#) 

Requirement 1 (Part 1)



SCENARIO

The company has well-defined release management processes for both large and small projects. However, its Salesforce development teams are facing some challenges and have the following requirements related to release management:

- 1) The company has seasonal business operations and approaching its busiest season. A development team has been working on a major Sales Cloud project. The Team Lead requires advice about releasing it in production, considering the impact on sales operations.



Requirement 1 (Part 2)



SCENARIO

- 2) A developer has created an Apex trigger and a record-triggered flow on the Opportunity object for a requirement of the sales director. The architect needs to recommend an approach for the release planning of these changes.
- 3) Moving forward, the CTO would like the release management processes to be created and executed by specific user groups for better control and management. The architect needs to provide an appropriate recommendation.



Solution 1 (Part 1)



SOLUTION

- 1) The company should **avoid launching** the major project in production **near peak business periods** to ensure that the impact on sales operations is minimal.
- 2) The release of the new Apex trigger and record-triggered flow should be planned as a **minor release** with **training** and **change management** practices. They represent minor changes that would not impact more than two or more groups of users and would have minor impact on training and production.



Solution 1 (Part 2)



SOLUTION

- 3) The **Center Of Excellence (COE)** and **Steering Committee** should be responsible for the creation and execution of release management processes. The Steering Committee provides **strategic direction and oversight**. The Center of Excellence (COE) plays a pivotal role in **standardizing and overseeing the execution of release management processes**.

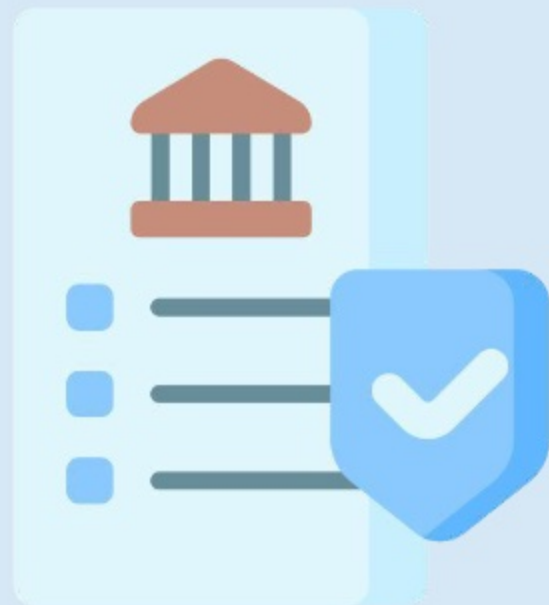


Requirement 2



SCENARIO

The company's CTO would like to develop a governance framework for release planning and has asked the architect for recommendations regarding decisions related to testing. In addition, one of the projects is in the testing phase, and the testing team has found several issues in the new functionality that will be deployed to production. As the project deadline is short, the team has proposed that the issues be fixed in the testing sandbox and then deployed to production. The architect needs to provide an appropriate recommendation.



Solution 2

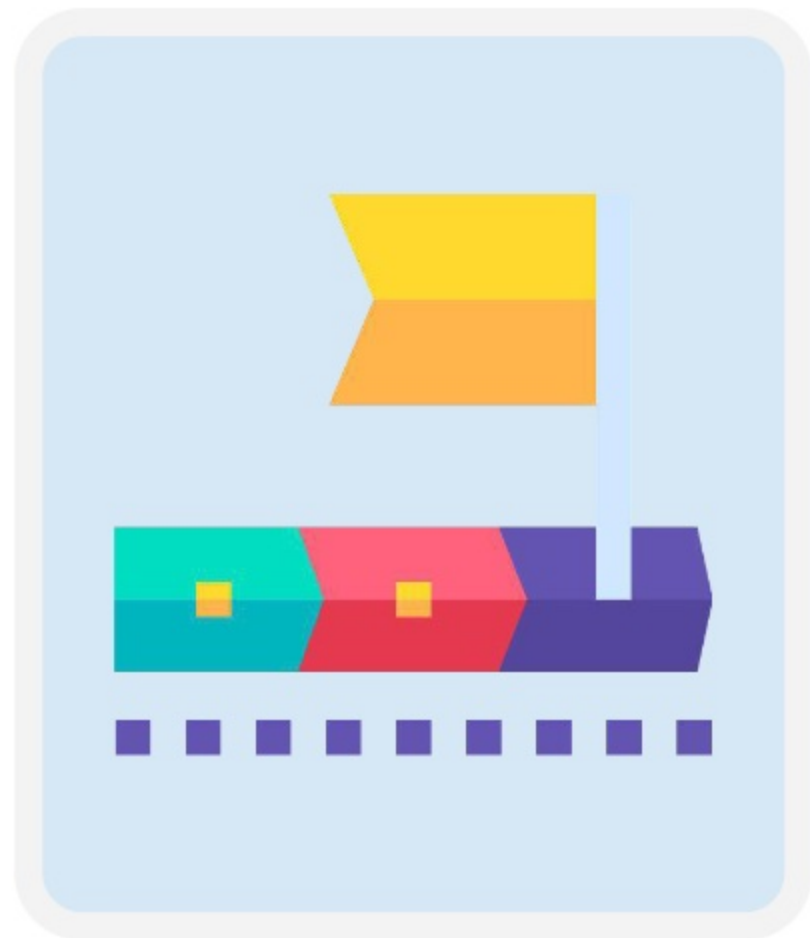


SOLUTION

In a governance framework for release planning, important decisions related to testing include the following:

- 1) When should a **new feature release** be tested in the development lifecycle, especially when issues are expected?
- 2) How should **existing functionality** be tested to ensure that **no regressions** are introduced?

The issues found by the testing team should be **fixed** in a **Developer sandbox**. The changes should then be **migrated to the testing sandbox** for thorough testing. Once testing is complete, they should be **deployed to production**.



Learn More

-  [Simplifying Salesforce Release Management](#)
-  [Top 7 Salesforce Release Management Best Practices](#)
-  [Change and Release Management](#)

